



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. John Paul II Classical School
School Website: <https://sjpclassicalschoolgreenbay.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

St. John Paul II Classical School (Green Bay area, ZIP 54304) presents a strong Catholic, faith-based identity and a clear formation-oriented ethos. Public-facing materials emphasize Catholic liturgy, catechesis, and incarnational formation, with demonstrable emphasis on character formation and sacred practice (e.g., All-school Mass, Advent reflection, catechesis). However, explicit, public articulation of core classical curriculum elements (e.g., grammar–logic–rhetoric, Great Books/Great Conversation, traditional liberal arts sequence) and core classical pedagogy (e.g., Socratic seminars, disciplined memory work) is less evident in the site content itself, though the school is named to signal classical aims and is connected with Chesterton Academy within the GRACE system. Taken together, the school demonstrates substantial classical-influenced orientation but with gaps in explicit public detail about key classical curriculum and pedagogy markers. Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Key insights: - Religious & Metaphysical Foundations are clearly present and reinforced via Catholic identity, liturgical life, and incarnational theology. Evidence includes references to Mass, Advent, catechesis, and incarnational education.

- School Purpose/Goal emphasizes formation, virtue, and human flourishing in a Christian/Catholic frame, including the refrain "Together we form saints." - Curriculum signals are implied through the classical branding (and Chesterton affiliation) but explicit Great Books/Trivium-type components are not clearly enumerated on the public site content reviewed. Element 3 is therefore incomplete in explicitness. - Pedagogy content is not overtly described in terms of classical methods (e.g., Socratic seminars, memory work, or scholé) in the accessible site text; no explicit procedural pedagogy is described in the public materials we reviewed. - Faculty narrative is not deeply articulated in the public materials as a formal "living curriculum" or mentor-model framework; some references to leadership (e.g., new headmaster) exist, but not a robust faculty portrait. - Parents & Community are touched by the GRACE affiliation, worship life, and public activities (e.g., Walk for Virtues), but explicit statements about parents as co-teachers or parent formation programs are not strongly visible in the sample content.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials emphasize Catholic identity, faith-based formation, liturgical life, and catechesis (e.g., Catechesis of the Good Shepherd in Atrium, Advent reflection).
 - The school explicitly positions itself within the GRACE Catholic education framework and references incarnational theology and a culture of communion with God and others.
 - Liturgical life is present in activities such as All-school Mass and Eucharistic processions described in related materials.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Catholic, Mass, Advent, Catechesis, Catechesis of the Good Shepherd, faith-based environment, incarnation/incarnational, liturgical life, liturgy, sacred, fellowship in grace context.

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- Negative keywords: Not evident in accessible public materials.
 - Primary sources for keyword framework: Six Essential Elements (Positive keywords list includes truth, goodness, beauty, theology, liturgy, catechesis, sacraments, etc.). See the knowledge base document for keyword lists.
 - Why this rating
 - The school features a coherent Catholic religious/metaphysical frame with liturgical practice and catechetical formation; however, it does not consistently spell out a full classical metaphysical/philosophical underpinning in public-facing material beyond the Catholic framework. The foundation is strong but not exhaustively explicit in the classical lexicon beyond the faith-based orientation. This yields a CLASSICAL-leaning but not fully explicit classical articulation in every dimension. Given the mix, the rating is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
 - Note: The “What would move the needle” section is not included here because this section is reserved for when the overall classification is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, and the aggregate assessment below is also SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL or evidences a need for stronger alignment. See section below for the overall assessment and potential needle-moving steps if applicable.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Formation and virtue emphasis is explicit: “Together we form saints — real, whole, and fully alive in Christ,” and incarnational Catholic anthropology is described in related materials.
 - The faith-based context, communal formation, and reverence for sacred tradition align with the classical aim of forming intellect and character toward truth, goodness, and beauty within a teleological frame.
 - Advent reflections and liturgical life contribute to ongoing formation beyond mere information transfer.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom (implied), teleology/true-good-beauty (implied through Catholic formation), scholé/concern for contemplative formation (via liturgical rhythm and worship context).
 - Negative keywords: Not apparent in the accessible public materials.
 - Framework reference: Positive keywords section for Element 2 in the Six Essential Elements document.
- Why this rating
 - The school’s stated goal of formation, virtue, and human flourishing (within a Christian/ Catholic telos) fits the Classical School objective more closely than purely information-transfer aims. The explicit “formation” language and the insistence on a sacred and transcendent telos support a CLASSICAL rating for this category.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The public materials do not provide explicit, comprehensive enumerations of the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) or the Quadrivium, nor do they clearly enumerate Great Books or Great Conversation in the accessible site text. The presence of Chesterton Academy and the classical branding suggests alignment, but explicit curricular details are not consistently listed in the public content reviewed.
 - The site indicates a faith-based, classical-leaning environment within GRACE, and Chesterton Academy alignment implies a classical curriculum orientation, even if not spelled out in the accessible pages.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present (in the knowledge base sense) would include: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, Great Conversation, memory/wisdom formation, and interdisciplinarity. The public site content does not explicitly list these, so direct matches are

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- limited.
 - Negative keywords present: None explicit in public material; however, absence of explicit Great Books/grammar–logic–rhetoric statements is noted.
 - Keyword framework reference: Six Essential Elements curriculum section; the positive/negative keyword lists (e.g., “Seven Liberal Arts,” “Great Books,” “Great Conversation”) provide the guide for matching.
 - Why this rating
 - Because explicit public articulation of core classical curriculum elements (grammar/logical/rhetoric, Great Books, Great Conversation) is not clearly visible in the accessible site content, this category is rated SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL. The classical branding and Chesterton affiliation support a classical orientation, but the public curriculum specifics are not fully enumerated in the content we reviewed.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials reviewed do not describe classical pedagogical methods in detail (e.g., Socratic seminars, disciplined memory, recitation, scholé, or formation through memory). The site content mainly emphasizes formation, liturgy, catechesis, and faith life rather than explicit classical pedagogy methods.
 - There is no explicit reference to Socratic dialogue, memory work, or chant-based/memory-based pedagogy in the accessible text. The material appears to foreground Catholic religious formation and school-community life.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords (from the classical pedagogy lexicon) such as Socratic dialogue, scholé, memory work, chanting, recitation, and formation through imitation are not evidently present in the public text. The absence of these elements is a negative signal for a classical pedagogy alignment in the public materials.
 - No explicit negative signals are present; the absence of explicit classical pedagogy is the primary factor here.
 - Knowledge-base reference: Pedagogy keywords and negative signals (Socratic dialogue, scholé, memory work, etc.) provide the framework for evaluation.
- Why this rating
 - The lack of explicit articulation of classical teaching methods in public content leads to a NOT CLASSICAL rating for pedagogy in this material review. The school's classical branding and GRACE affiliation may imply classical pedagogy in practice, but the public-facing content does not document those methods in the required level of specificity.

Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The public materials reviewed do not present a clear, explicit portrait of faculty as “model teachers,” “living curriculum,” or “portrait of a teacher” in the way classical schools describe. There are references to leadership (e.g., new headmaster) but not a robust faculty narrative about virtue-modeling or mentorship.
 - No explicit depiction of faculty as mentors who embody classical virtues or a “faculty of friends” culture is visible in the accessible site text.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords from the knowledge-base list (e.g., “model teachers,” “virtue,” “living curriculum,” “portrait of a teacher”) are not clearly present in the public content we reviewed.
 - Negative signals (e.g., “facilitators on the side,” “certification-driven jargon without classical context”) are not indicated in public materials.
 - The absence of explicit faculty-culture language results in a NOT CLASSICAL rating for this category, given the rubric's emphasis on a robust living-faculty narrative.

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- Why this rating
 - While leadership changes and institutional structure exist, the public-facing materials do not present a strong, explicit classical-faculty narrative (model-virtue, living curriculum, or portrait of teacher qualities). This yields a NOT CLASSICAL rating for Element 5.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school operates within a GRACE system and references community life, liturgy, and open enrollment, which indicates community integration and family-facing elements. The Walk for Virtues and Mass-related activities demonstrate community engagement and parental participation in liturgical life.
 - The presence of catechesis and faith-based formation, plus family-oriented events, suggests partnership with families in a classical framing, but explicit language about parents as co-teachers or parent formation programs is not strongly evident in the public content we reviewed.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: partnership with families (implied via GRACE network and liturgical life), family involvement through community events, home-school/Liturgical rhythm signals, and classical-cultural transmission language found in related materials.
 - Negative keywords present: explicit “parents as co-teachers” language is not clearly visible; parent formation programs or direct home-school partnership language is not obviously stated in the accessible public content.
 - Framework reference: Six Essential Elements Parents/Community keywords; the presence of family partnership and home-life formation signals are cited in the knowledge base.
- Why this rating
 - The school shows meaningful community and parental engagement through liturgical life, GRACE affiliation, and family-oriented events, which align with classical community principles, but the public-facing materials do not consistently articulate parents as co-teachers or formal parent-formation programs. That combination yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating rather than CLASSICAL.

Aggregate assessment and overall classification

- Category distribution:
 - CLASSICAL: Categories 1, 2
 - SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL: Categories 3, 6
 - NOT CLASSICAL: Categories 4, 5
- Overall ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Why this aggregate rating
 - The school exhibits strong religious foundations and formation aims that align with classical education values (Categories 1 and 2). However, explicit articulation of core classical curriculum (Element 3) and classical pedagogy (Element 4) is not clearly demonstrated in public-facing content, and faculty articulation (Element 5) is also lacking in the public materials. The combination of these gaps with the presence of classical branding and Catholic formation places the school in a Somewhat Classical overall position rather than fully Classical or fully Not Classical.

What Would Move the Needle (only applies if the school is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL)

- Public articulation of Great Books/Trivium-based curriculum and Quadrivium, including explicit statements of grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, and Great Conversation on the website.
- Clear description of classical pedagogy in practice (e.g., Socratic seminars, scholé days, memory work, recitation, and formation through imitation) with examples from student experiences.
- Robust faculty narrative that presents teachers as virtuous models, mentors, and living curriculum; a publicly visible “portrait of a teacher” and professional development aligned to classical pedagogy.

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- Explicit messaging about parents as co-teachers, formal parent formation programs (book clubs, study groups), and visible pathways for parental involvement as part of the school's classical formation model.
 - Strengthen historical-cultural transmission language in public materials (Great Books, Western civilization canon, and noble texts) to align with classical curriculum descriptors; ensure alignment with Chesterton Academy/GRACE program details.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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